

GIANT ANTEATER AND RELATIVES

Native to Central and South America, the Myrmecophagidae have an elongated snout and a long tongue. They use their powerful claws to rip open termite mounds and ant hills. Lacking teeth, they catch insects with their sticky saliva and spine-covered tongue.



SOUTHERN TAMANDUA *Tamandua tetradactyla*

This solitary species has a prehensile tail. It forages for food at any time of day, and is active for about 7 hours in every 24.

GIANT ANTEATER *Myrmecophaga tridactyla*

The largest anteater, with a tail almost as long as its body, this species uses its long, sticky tongue to catch up to 30,000 insects a day.

RABBITS, HARES, AND PIKAS

Two herbivorous families make up the order known as Lagomorpha. Their apparent similarities to rodents result from adaptation to a common lifestyle.

These species occupy a variety of habitats, from tropical forest to Arctic tundra. All are terrestrial herbivores or browsers. They are gnawing animals and share the diet of many rodents. Like those of rodents, the teeth of rabbits, hares, and pikas continue to grow throughout life – they are worn down by chewing. However, there are fundamental differences between the groups: rabbits and their relatives have four incisors in the upper jaw, while rodents have only two.

Relying on food that is relatively slow to break down, these animals have a modified digestive

system. They produce two types of faeces: moist pellets, which are eaten to gain further nutrients from the food, and dry pellets passed as waste.

ESCAPING PREDATORS

Pikas, the most rodent-like species in this order, take refuge from predators in burrows and crevices after raising the alarm with a whistle. Rabbits and hares, in contrast, have long ears to detect danger and powerful limbs to flee from predators. These animals have large eyes positioned high on each side of the head to provide almost 360-degree vision. When a predator is observed, hares drum their hind legs on the ground in warning.

PHYLUM	CHORDATA
CLASS	MAMMALIA
ORDER	LAGOMORPHA
FAMILIES	2
SPECIES	OVER 90



To survive the winter, the pika collects various plants, creates a hay pile of dried food, and stores it in its den.

RABBITS AND HARES

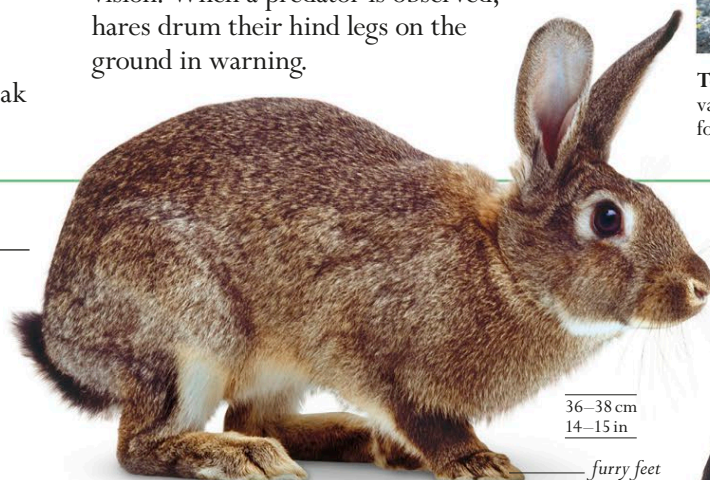
Native across much of the world, the Leporidae have long, movable ears and enlarged hind legs to detect and escape predators. Large eyes reflect their mainly nocturnal habits. Rabbits often inhabit permanent burrow systems, whereas the more solitary hares make only transitory shelters.



13–18 cm
5–7 in

DWARF RABBIT *Oryctolagus cuniculus*

One of the smallest breeds, the dwarf rabbit occurs in many colours and patterns. Its rounded face and small ears make it a popular pet.



36–38 cm
14–15 in

ANGORA RABBIT *Oryctolagus cuniculus*

Valued for its long, soft hair, which is spun into yarn, this breed originates from Anatolia (in modern-day Turkey).



25–38 cm
10–15 in



15–30 cm
6–12 in

LOP-EARED RABBIT *Oryctolagus cuniculus*

First bred in England in the 19th century, this type has long, lop-eared (floppy) ears. There is variation in both colour and size.